partnership was determined to end her isolation. Therefore, there developed a rapprochement between the two to balance off Russia. It was under these circumstances that India concluded with the Soviet Union, The Indo–Soviet Treaty of Peace Friendship and Cooperation in August 1971. This treaty provided that the two countries would keep in touch with each other on major international problems affecting the interests of both the parties. They agreed not to enter into or participate in military alliance, which is directed against any one of them. The treaty stipulated that if there was aggression against any of the two parties, they would immediately consult each other on how to meet the aggression. They would abstain from providing assistance to any third party that emerged in armed conflict with one of them. The Treaty was like a shield against both Washington and Chinese designs of any military action against India in the unfolding Bangladesh Crisis.

India played a prominent role in the emergence of Bangladesh, which became an independent state on 16 December 1971 after the surrender of the Pakistani troops in the erstwhile East Bengal to the Indian army. India gave immediate recognition to the state of Bangladesh. Ultimately, the Indo–Pak relations were normalized with the Simla Summit held on 1 July 1972 which sought to resolve several thorny issues in their bilateral relations. The Simla Agreement provided that:

1. Both the parties would resolve their differences by peaceful means through bilateral negotiations, and committed themselves to peaceful coexistence, respect for each other's territorial integrity, sovereignty and non-interference in each other's internal affairs.
2. Hostile propaganda against each other would be stopped.
3. Meeting between the Heads of the two countries would be convened to discuss the future ways and means for the establishment of durable peace and normalization of relations.

Mrs. Gandhi too was keen on improving India's relations with other neighbours such as Nepal and Sri Lanka. She adopted a soft policy towards Nepal and even visited Nepal in October 1966 and held out largest aid package for India's small neighbour. She always tried to